(c) must be a member of one of the Houses of the Parliament.
(d) must be a member of the Lok Sabha.

Ans. (a): The Prime Minister is appointed by the president. The minimum age required is 25 years, as he can be a member of either house if not, must be within 6 months. In normal circumstances, the president can hardly exercise his discretion; the presidents choice to appoint the Prime Minister is restricted to the leader of the party with majority of Lok Sabha. The correct option is (b).

42. In the parliament of India, the purpose of an adjournment motion is-
(a) to allow a discussion on a definite matter of urgent public importance.
(b) to let opposition members collect information from the ministers.
(c) to allow a reduction of specific amount in demand for grant.
(d) to postpone the proceedings to check the inappropriate or violent behaviour on the part of some members.

Ans. (a): The purpose of bringing an adjournment motion in the Indian Parliament is to debate a certain urgent issue of public importance. There are many meetings per day in a session that are separated by adjournment. By adjournment, the consideration of the working of the house is deferred for a specified period of time. It can also be of a period of a few hours, days or weeks.

43. Which of the following can be said to be essentially the parts of 'Inclusive Governance' ?
1. Permitting the Non-Banking Financial Companies to do banking.
2. Establishing effective District planning Committees in all the districts.
3. Increasing the government spending on public health.
4. Strengthening the Mid-day Meal Scheme.

Select the correct answer using the codes given below:
(a) 1 and 2 only (b) 3 and 4 only
(c) 2, 3 and 4 (d) 1, 2, 3 and 4

Ans. (c): Inclusive governance refers to a regime in which the people belonging to the most vulnerable section of society get a fair share in the distribution of national income generated at a high economic growth rate. From this perspective, empowering the 'mid-day meal' scheme, increasing government expenditure on public health, setting up effective district planning committees in all districts will be called part of inclusive governance. Permitting the non-banking financial companies to do banking is not the essential part of the 'Inclusive Governance'.

• Centre-State Relations,Administration, State of Jammu & Kashmir (now UT)

44. In India, other than ensuring that public funds, are used efficiently and for intended purpose, what is the importance of the office of the Comptroller and Auditor General (CAG) ?
1. CAG exercises exchequer control on behalf of the Parliament when the President of India declares national emergency/financial emergency.
2. CAG reports on the execution of projects or programmes by the ministries are discussed by the Public accounts Committee.
3. Information from CAG reports can be used by investigating agencies to press charges against those who have violated the law while managing public finances.
4. While dealing with the audit and accounting of government companies, CAG has certain judicial powers for prosecuting those who violate the law.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?
(a) 1, 3 and 4 (b) 2 only
(c) 2 and 3 only (d) 1, 2, 3 and 4

Ans. (c) : CAG reports on execution of projects or programmes by the Public Accounts Committee.
- Information from CAG reports can be used by investigating agencies to press charges against those who have violated the law while managing public finance.
- Only (2) and (3) are correct statements.

45. The distribution of powers between the Centre and the States in the Indian Constitution is based on the scheme provided in the-
(a) Morley-Minto Reforms, 1909
(b) Montagu-Chelmsford Act, 1919
(c) Government of India Act, 1935
(d) Indian Independence Act, 1947

Ans. (c): In the constitution of India, the separation of powers between the center and the states is based on the Government of India Act, 1935. The federal system consists of two governments and the division of powers between them. The federal polity depends on the co-ordination between these two governments.

46. Which of the following are the methods of Parliamentary control over public finance in India?
1. Placing Annual Financial Statement before the Parliament.
2. Withdrawal of money from Consolidated Fund of India only after passing the Appropriation Bill.
3. Provisions of supplementary grants and vote-on-account.
4. A periodic or at least a mid-year review of programme of the Government against macroeconomic forecasts and expenditure by a Parliamentary Budget Office.
5. Introducing Finance Bill in the Parliament.

Select the correct answer using the codes given below:
(a) 1, 2, 3, and 5 only (b) 1, 2 and 4 only
(c) 3, 4 and 5 only (d) 1, 2, 3, 4 and 5

Ans. (a): Parliament exercises the following types of control over the expenditure by placing annual financial statement before the parliament under Article 112. Under Article 114, it is given that no money can be withdrawn from the Consolidated Fund of India without passing Appropriation Bills.
Provisions of supplementary grants and vote-on-accounts is given in Article 115 and Article 116 respectively. Article 107 stipulate provisions for Finance Bill.

• Category-Special Provisions, Scheduled/ Tribal Areas

47. With reference to the Delimitation Commission. consider the following statements :
1. The orders of the Delimitation Commission cannot be challenged in a Court of Law.
2. When the orders of the Delimitation Commission are laid before the Lok Sabha or State Legislative Assembly, they cannot effect any modifications in the orders.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?
(a) 1 only (b) 2 only
(c) Both 1 and 2 (d) Neither 1 nor 2

Ans. (c) : The Government of India established the Delimitation Commission under the provisions of the Delimitation Commission Act. Delimitation Commission has been set up four times in the past - 1952,1962,1972 and 2002 Under Delimitation Acts of 1952,1962,1972, and 2002.
The commission is a powerful and independent body whose orders cannot be challenged in any court of law. The orders are laid before the Lok Sabha and the respective State Legislative Assemblies. However, modifications are not permitted.

• Judiciary (Centre and State)

48. What is the provision to safeguard the autonomy of the Supreme Court of India ?
1. While appointing the Supreme Court Judges, the President of India has to consult the Chief Justice of India.
2. The Supreme Court Judges can be removed by the Chief Justice of India only.
3. The salaries of the Judges are charged on the Consolidated Fund of India to which the legislature does not have to vote.
4. All appointments of officers and staffs of the Supreme Court of India are made by the Government only after consulting the Chief Justice of India.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?
(a) 1 and 3 only (b) 3 and 4 only
(c) 4 only (d) 1, 2, 3 and 4

Ans. (a): Every judge of the Supreme Court shall be appointed by the President. The President may consult other persons for this purpose in addition to the advice of ministers. In addition to the appointment of other judges of the Supreme Court, it is mandatory to consult the Chief Justice of India (Article 124). It has been provided that the administrative expenses of the Supreme Court and the salaries, allowances etc. of the Judges and other staff of the Supreme Court will be charged on the Consolidated Fund of India. i.e., Parliament cannot vote on them (Article 146).

49. Which of the following are included in the original jurisdiction of the Supreme Court:
1. A dispute between the Government of India and one or more States.
2. A dispute regarding elections to either House of the Parliament or that of Legislature of a State.
3. A dispute between the Government of India and a Union Territory.
4. A dispute between two or more states.

Select the correct answer using the codes given below:
(a) 1 and 2 (b) 2 and 3
(c) 1 and 4 (d) 3 and 4

Ans. (c): The original jurisdiction of the Supreme Court Subject to the provisions of Article 131 of the indian Constitution, the Supreme Court shall, to the exclusion of any other court, have original jurisdiction in any dispute: (a) between the Government of India and one or more States; or (b) between the Government of India and any State or States on one side and one or more other States on the other; or (c) between two or more States, if and in so far as the dispute involves any question (whether of law or fact) on which the existence or extent of a legal right depends.

• Panchayati Raj System and Constitution Amendments and Schedules

50. In the areas covered under the Panchayat (Extension to the Scheduled Areas) Act, 1996, what is the role/power of Gram Sabha?
1. Gram Sabha has the power to prevent alienation of land in the Scheduled Areas.
2. Gram Sabha has the ownership of minor forest produce.
3. Recommendation of Gram Sabha is required for granting prospecting licence or mining lease for any mineral in the Scheduled Areas.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?
(a) 1 only (b) 1 and 2 only
(c) 2 and 3 only (d) 1, 2 and 3

Ans. (d): As per the provisions of the Panchayats (Extensions to Scheduled Areas) Act, 1996, Gram Sabha has ownership of minor forest produce and stops the transfer of land in scheduled areas mining for any mineral in scheduled area. The recommendation of Gram Sabha is also necessary for grant of lease and prospecting license.

ECONOMICS

• Developing and Developed Economy

51. Under, which of the following circumstances may 'capital gains' arise ?
1. When there is an increase in the sales of product.
2. When there is a natural increase in the value of the property owned.
3. When you purchase a painting and there is a growth in its value due to increase in its popularity.

Select the correct answer using the codes given below:
(a) 1 only (b) 2 and 3 only
(c) only 2 (d) 1, 2 and 3

Ans. (b): Capital gains arise when there is a natural increase in the value of the property owned and when you purchase a painting and there is a growth in its value due to an increase in its popularity.